Yishan Wang

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yishani.github.io | GitHub | Google Scholar | LinkedIn

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Audio-language models; multimodal learning; voice agents and discourse; agentic learning; self-improving systems; AI for scientific discovery.

EDUCATION

Eindhoven University of Technology Jun. 2025 – present
PhD research in multimodal AI agents *Netherlands*

- Department of Industrial Design. Advisors: Aaqib Saeed and Mathias Funk. Expected completion: May 2029.

University of Amsterdam Sep. 2022 – Sep. 2024
MSc Brain and Cognitive Sciences (Research) *Netherlands*

- **Selected coursework:** Advanced Topics in Philosophy of Language, Computational Cognitive Neuroscience, Research Design & Statistics, Neuroimaging.

Peking University Sep. 2018 – Jul. 2022
BA Philosophy (Science & Logic) *China*

- **Selected coursework:** Philosophy of Language, Mathematical Logic, Epistemology, Cognitive Psychology, Experimental Psychology, Probability and Statistics.

PUBLICATIONS

[J] Peer-reviewed journal article; [C] Peer-reviewed conference paper; [P] Preprint.

[P] **Yishan Wang**, Ran Piao, Mathias Funk, and Aaqib Saeed. SimAuthor: Harnessing Foundation Models for Persistent Scientific Simulator Authoring. *arXiv preprint*, arXiv:2610.06257, 2026.

[J] **Yishan Wang**, Tsai-Ning Wang, Mathias Funk, and Aaqib Saeed. StethoLM: Audio Language Model for Cardiopulmonary Analysis Across Clinical Tasks. *Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR)*, 2026. Presented at ICML 2026, Journal-to-Conference track. [Code] [Model] [Dataset]

[C] **Yishan Wang**, Amanda Cercas Curry, and Flor Miriam Plaza-del-Arco. Your Mileage May Vary: How Empathy and Demographics Shape Human Preferences in LLM Responses. *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP*, pp. 17257–17270, 2025.

[C] **Yishan Wang**, Pia Sommerauer, and Jelke Bloem. The Negation Bias in Large Language Models: Investigating Bias Reflected in Linguistic Markers. *Conference on Language Modeling (COLM)*, 2025.

OTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Collaborator Oct. 2024 – May 2025
MilaNLP, Bocconi University *Remote*

- Studied demographic and empathy-related variation in preferences for LLM responses with Flor Miriam Plaza-del-Arco and Amanda Cercas Curry; published in EMNLP Findings 2025.

Research Intern Mar. 2024 – Sep. 2024
Computational Linguistics & Text Mining Lab, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam *Netherlands*

- Investigated implicit bias in masked and autoregressive language models through linguistic markers and social-psychological frameworks; developed dataset curation and evaluation procedures.
- Supervisors: Pia Sommerauer and Antske Fokkens.

Research Intern Feb. 2023 – Oct. 2023
Cognitive AI & Vision Amsterdam (CAVA) Lab, University of Amsterdam *Netherlands*

- Mapped deep neural network embeddings to human behavioral and brain data using representational similarity analysis, Python, and PyTorch.
- Supervisor: H. Steven Scholte.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Conference reviewer: NeurIPS 2026; ICLR 2027; AAAI 2027.

SKILLS

Programming: Python (PyTorch, NumPy, pandas), R, LaTeX.
Methods: Multimodal modeling and evaluation, dataset curation, experimental design, statistical analysis, representational similarity analysis.
Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent).